Two Homes, One County

A Data-Driven Home Search for William Rodriguez



King County Housing Market Analysis · Sales from May 2014 – May 2015

William Rodriguez — buyer, household of 2

Meet the Client



City Home

- Needs to move fast
- Wants a central location



Country Home

- Best possible timing to buy
- Open to (actually prefers) non-renovated homes

BUSINESS QUESTION

What factors influence the price of homes in King County?

Every finding and recommendation in this deck traces back to this one question — answered specifically for William's two searches, not the market in general.



What We Looked At

21,597

home sales analyzed

12 months

May 2014 – May 2015

King County

Seattle & surrounding area

Sale records were joined against county property details — size, condition, location, and renovation history — for every transaction in the window.

Three Hypotheses We Tested



Hypothesis 1 — Does location drive price?



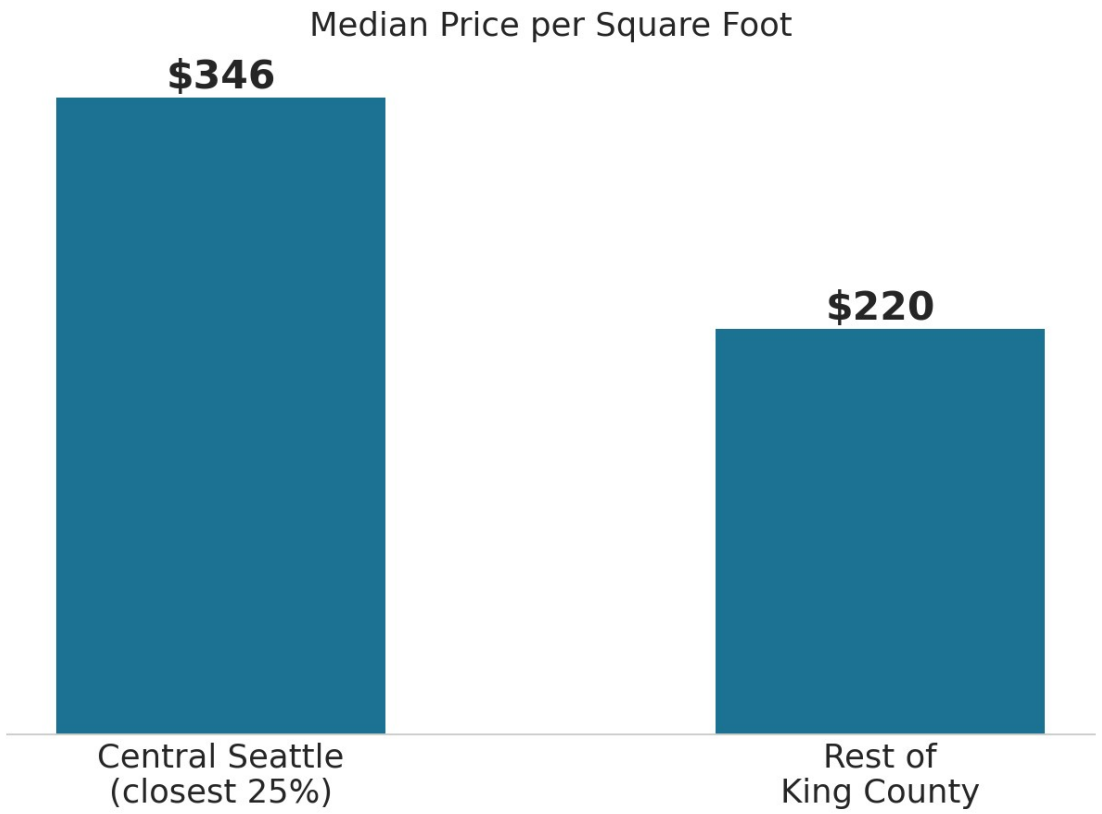
Hypothesis 2 — Does renovation status matter?



Hypothesis 3 — Is there a best time to buy?

Location Commands a Premium

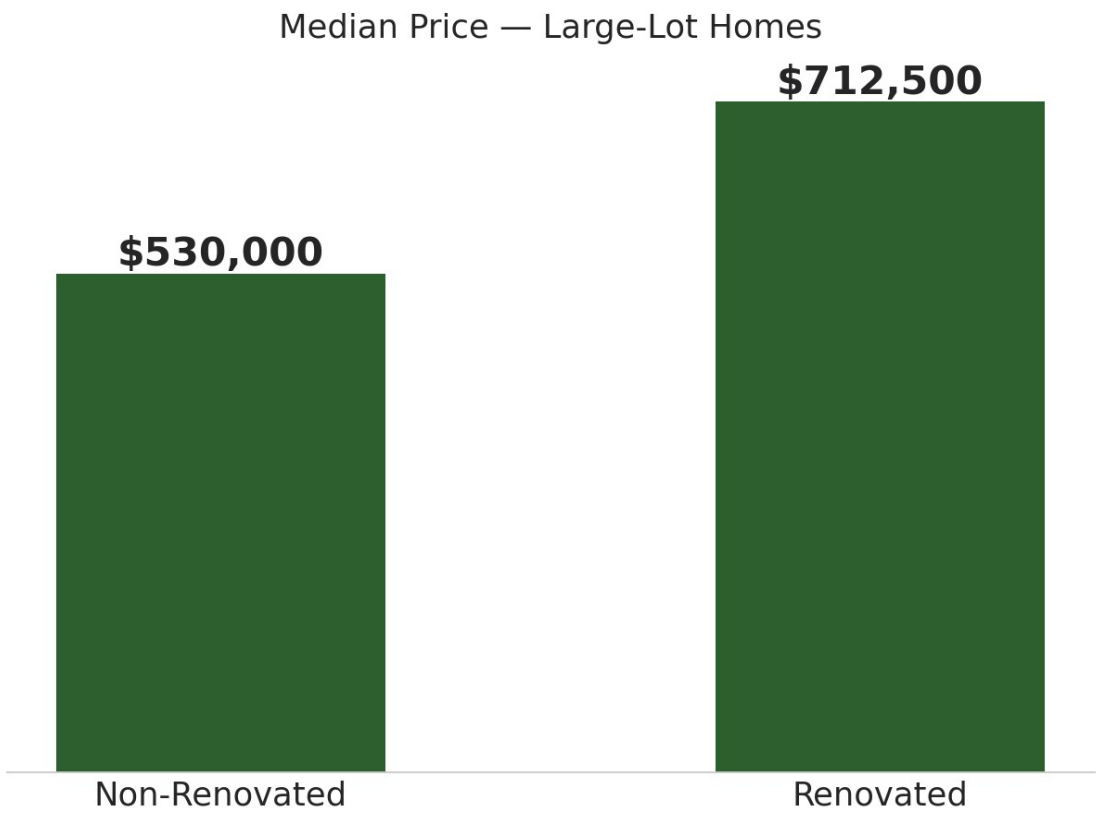
BOTTOM LINE: a home within ~6 miles of downtown Seattle costs about 57% more per square foot than one farther out.



Large-lot “country” homes don’t sell for less overall — but they do cost less per square foot of living space, since the buyer is paying for land, not finished floor area.

Non-Renovated Homes Cost Less — By Design

BOTTOM LINE: non-renovated homes are both the norm (97% of listings) and the cheaper option — a ~34% savings among large-lot homes.

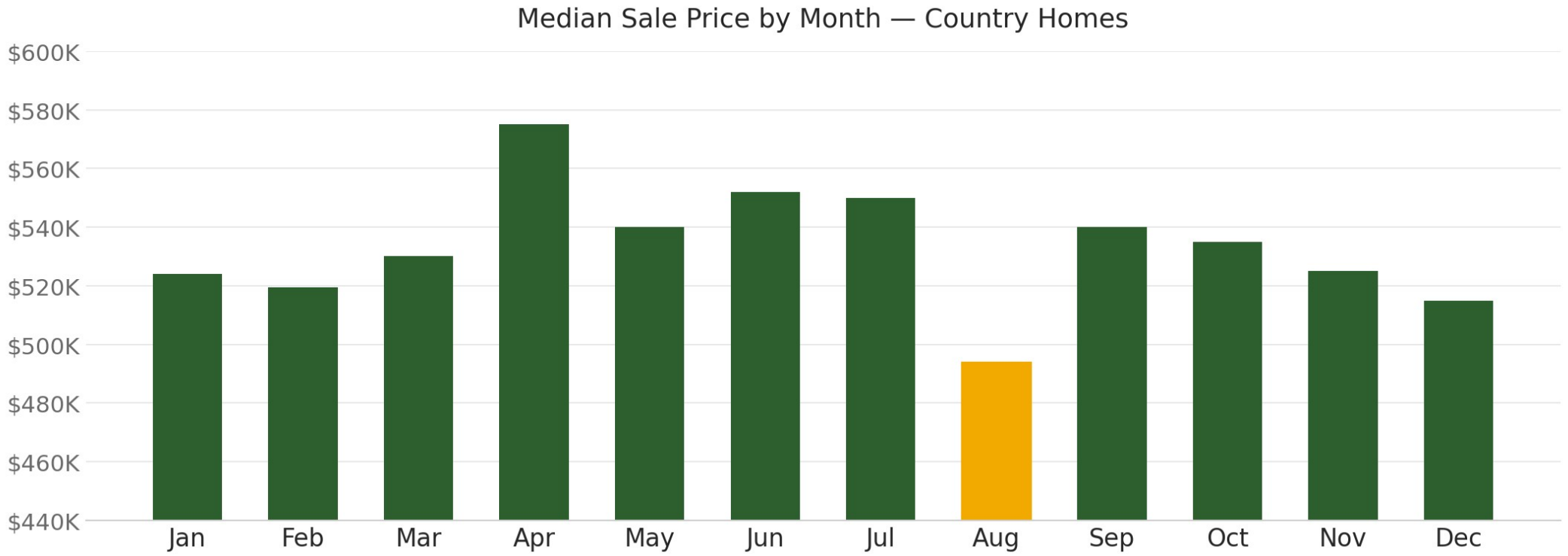


97% of King County homes have no renovation on record. Non-renovated isn't a compromise here — it's the typical listing, which lines up well with William's stated preference.

When You Buy Determines What You Pay

BOTTOM LINE: for country homes, August is the cheapest month to close (median $493,725) — worth timing around if savings matter most.

Country homes specifically — city homes follow a different, later-year pattern.



Aug – $493,725

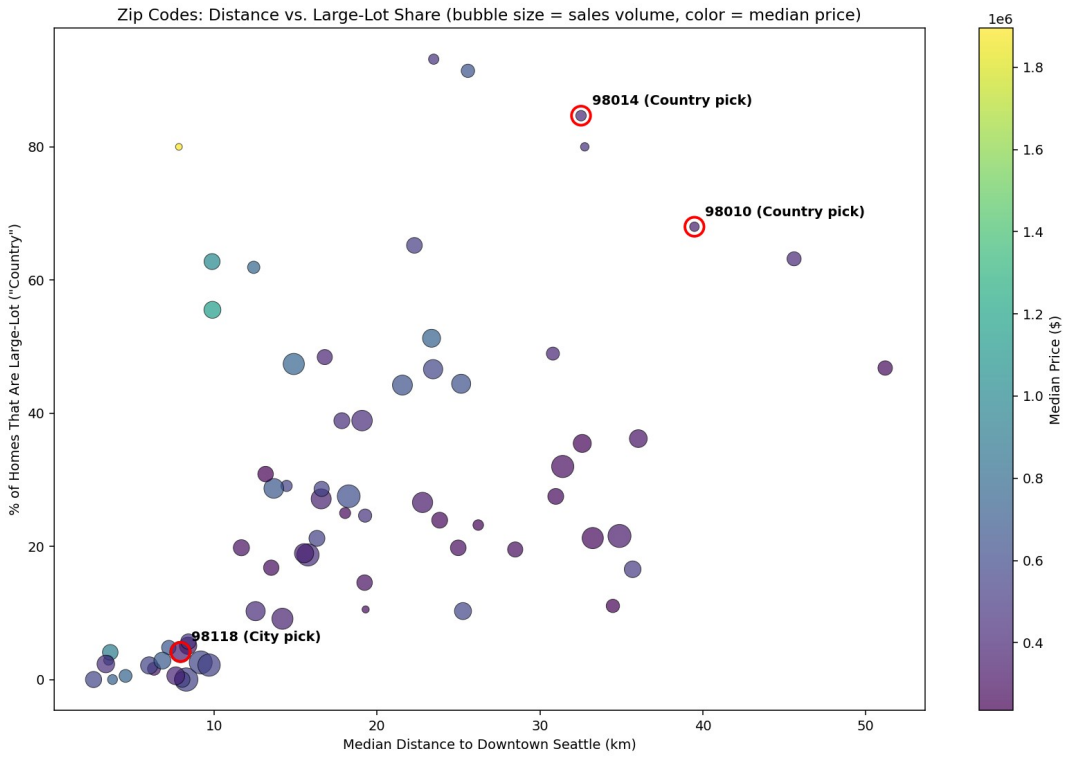
cheapest median price for country homes

May – 604 sales

most country-home listings to choose from

For the City Home → Zip 98118

BOTTOM LINE: 98118 is the closest high-turnover, affordable zip to downtown — the strongest match for "fast and central."



Distance vs. large-lot share, sized by sales, colored by price — 98118 circled.

7.9 km

from downtown Seattle — the closest of the high-turnover zips

507 sales

in the 12-month window — highest turnover among affordable central zips

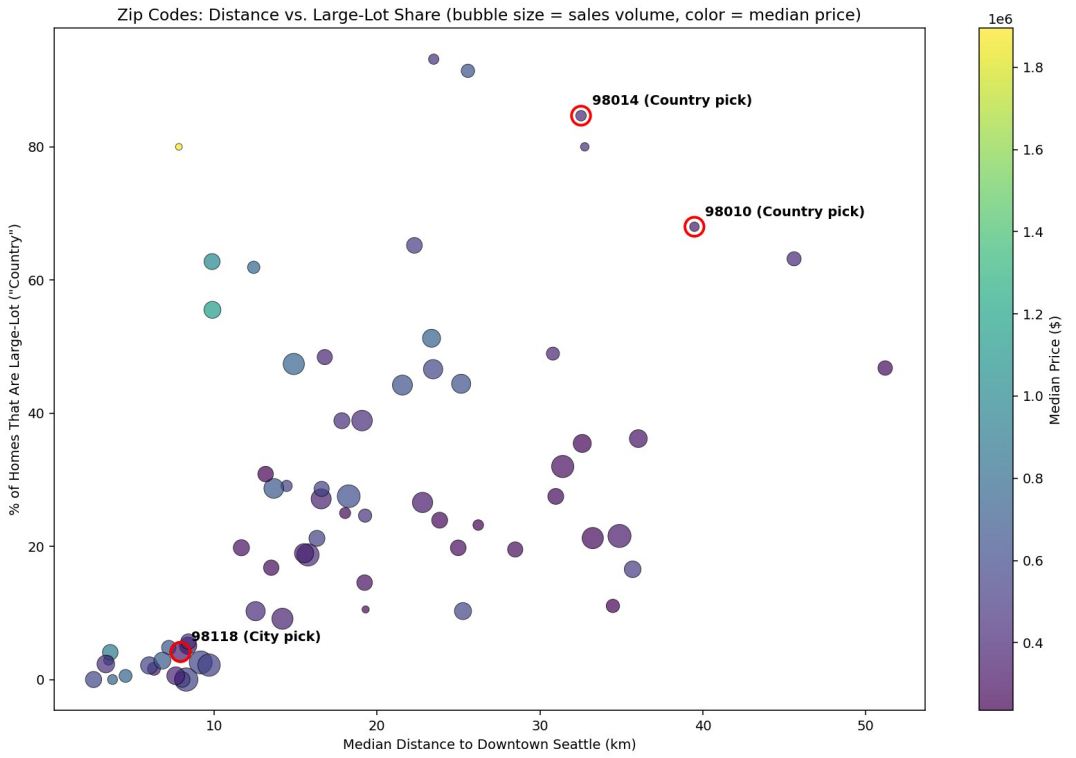
$367,500

median price — the most affordable of that group

98103, 98115, and 98117 are strong second choices. Filter to 1–3 bedrooms — plenty for a household of 2, avoiding a ~41% size premium.

For the Country Home → Zip 98010 or 98014

BOTTOM LINE: 98010 and 98014 are genuinely rural, affordable, and still liquid enough to search — the strongest match for William's timing and non-renovated preference.



Distance vs. large-lot share, sized by sales, colored by price — 98010 & 98014 circled.

30+ km

from downtown — genuinely rural, not just "outside city limits"

68–85%

of homes in these zips are large-lot — real country character

$360K–$415K

median price — well below the county median

Lean into non-renovated listings here — they're the majority of homes and meaningfully cheaper.

Final Recommendations



City home

Target zip 98118 — closest high-turnover, affordable zip to downtown. Filter to 1–3 bedrooms.



Country home

Target zip 98010 or 98014 — genuinely rural and affordable. Lean into non-renovated listings.



Timing

Country home: close in August for the lowest price ($493,725), or May for ~18% more inventory at only a ~9% premium. City home: timing matters less since speed comes first, but November is the cheapest month ($537,500) if there's flexibility — the two searches don't share one seasonal pattern.



Thank You

Questions & discussion